

Cinematic Universe including The Wolf Man, Dracula, Frankenstein, The Invisible Man and more.

ELECTRIC AND HYBRID VEHICLES

The reason we've clumped the two together is because they happened pretty close to each other, time-wise. Apparently, not everyone is sure about who first decided to put a battery in a car, but William Morrison's Morrison Electric in the 1890s is widely considered to be the first electric automobile. Morrison was what you would call a battery enthusiast,



and figured out a way to install lightweight storage batteries onto a coach. Unfortunately, electric cars would not take off, because their gas counter-parts were simply cheaper to produce and had a far greater range.

Ferdinand Porsche was the first to develop a drive system that worked by fitting electric motors to each of the front wheels around the year 1900. The racing version of the vehicle would be called the "Porsche". The electric motors were petrol driven, where petrol was used to drive a generator to produce electricity to drive the motors. Technically, that also makes this hybrid vehicle the first to use 4-wheel drive.

SELFIES



Imagine that, the first ever selfie came about even before the word was coined. Dating back to 1839, Robert Cornelius is credited with having taken the first ever "selfie".

He was an amateur chemist and photography enthusiast who took the photo on his camera that was set up in the back of his family store. How did he take it? As was typical in cameras back then, he took

MODERN THINGS THAT ARE ACTUALLY ANCIENT

Polyhedral dice



The 20-sided die is currently synonymous with Dungeons & Dragons, however, it was apparently a thing in Ancient Egypt as well. Yep, that's over 2000 years ago. There's still speculation about what they were used for, there are suggestions that say board games, and some that say they were used for divination. For all you know the Egyptians were the first to actually play D&D, who knows.

Chewing gum



While the "gum" we chew today is vastly different (and flavoured), back in the day (like way way back in this case)

Dating back to over 10,000 years ago, chewing gum, it appears, is a grand human tradition.

humans were chewing tree bark. The chewed gum actually had a purpose other than recreation in those days, as it could be used as an adhesive substance.

Animation



The thaumatrope is a device that's often considered an important antecedent of animation. It was initially thought

that the first thaumatrope was created a few hundred years ago, in the Victorian Age. New evidence suggests however that Paleolithic artists may have invented the thaumatrope, thousands of years ago. The evidence comes in the form of Magdalenian bone discs, pierced in the centre, decorated on both sides with animals shown in different positions. Additionally, there's also the thought that Stone Age cave painters may have created their cave paintings in a way they came to life depending on the flickering of flames.

off the lens cap, ran into frame and sat there for a good minute before covering the lens up again.

LOCAL POSITIONING SYSTEM



Before satellite navigation came along and became the norm (what we know as GPS today), we had scroll maps to help with navigation while driving. This navigation system dates back to the 1920s-30s, most famously by Iter-Auto. Iter-Auto's contraption was mounted next to the car's speedometer, which it was hooked to. The scroll would wind as the car moved, proportional to distance travelled. This in turn "updated" the map as the scroll winded, showing you upcoming features like turns, bridges, hotels and more. Different routes had

different scrolls, and you could update the scrolls depending on your start location before popping them into the contraption. The only issue was that it only worked for mostly straight routes, and veering even slightly off-course could result in the map becoming ineffective. But in cases where it could be used, it was actually pretty accurate. Unfortunately, it never took off, because of the extremely limited number of cars on the roads at the time.

LOLCATS

You know how the internet is really just a place for people to share cute pictures of cats? Well, it turns out people have been obsessed with sharing cute pictures of cats for ages. Well over a century really. Dating back to the early 1800s even. The images were on trade cards, and showed the cats doing all kinds of things such as driving vehicles, having tea parties and playing games. The internet just made things easier. 🐱